

Gold Standard Examples Template — Research Plan

Use this in the **Gold Standard Examples** field:

Sample 1 — StayNow — Research Plan

StayNow Research Plan - Formative Research Last Updated: October 28, 2020 Background & Purpose StayNow is an AI-powered end to end travel planning and booking platform that helps users discover, plan, and book trips in one place. The purpose of this study is to understand the journey of a guest while searching for, shortlisting, booking, staying at, and anything after staying in a boutique/independent hotel. The main focus will be to comprehend what could drive loyalty, trust, adoption, and retention of guests on a new booking platform. It will be leveraged to collect insights that will be used to quantify the pervasiveness of statements for a larger audience. Research Goals By the end of this study, we should understand/know: ● Who the user is and the problems they are trying to solve ● What do we need to provide to guests to help them make a decision on the platform ● What the aspirational world we need to deliver is ● How to drive retention and advocacy ● What value do we need to provide to guests and how to deliver the most worthwhile experience ● How to drive adoption and retention Collated Research Questions 1. [Journey] What does the guest journey look like? (Goal: understanding the user and the problems they are trying to solve) ● How long does it take to book in expedia? ● What is the distribution of sources that people use to search for hotels? ● How do you speed up the process of booking? ● How often do people change their reservation? ● What are some common reasons to call for support? ● What kind of requests are front desk people keep getting? ● What method of checking is the most desirable? ● What is the barrier to entry for guests? ● What are the pain points in their journey? ● What is the milestone for checkout? ● What are the different methods of check out? ● When do guests request an early check in ? ● How often do you use support for your hotel experiences? ● How often and why do people go to support? ● What defines check out? ● Why do people ask for a late check out? ● What are the pain points of the search experience? ● What is the booking journey? ● Where do they go to book? 2. [Decision-making] How do guests make a decision on which hotel to book? (Goal: Understand what we need to provide to guests to help them make a decision on the platform) ● Which elements would they take in count to make a decision? ● Where do people search for hotels? ● Where are people looking for prices? ● How do people search for hotels? ● Do people notice the difference between hotel ads and a good deal on Google? ● What is the role of social media in the search process? ● How can StayNow be the surface at the top of the search results in Google? ● Is price difference something important when you are

shortlisting? How big has to be the difference? ● What criteria do they consider to shortlist a hotel? ● Why select a boutique hotel? ● How important are ratings when guests are selecting a hotel? 3. [Ideal Experience] What is the guest's ideal end to end journey? (Goal: Understand the aspirational world we need to deliver) ● How to create a good experience for customers? ● Do front desk employees have insights about the guests' experience? ● What is the check in experience expectation? ● What defines a good stay? ● What was the last bad experience that you had staying in an independent hotel? ● What is preventing guests from staying in an independent hotel? ● What was your last walk out experience? Why did you walk out? ● How do you measure a good or bad stay? ● What makes a good or bad support experience? ● What makes a good or bad experience when checking out? ● How often the support expectations are met? ● What is the current independent hotel experience? ● What is the expectation of the hotel experience? ● What would people like to have the hotel experience like? ● How has been the experience in the boutique hotel? 4. [Driving loyalty] What drives customer (guest) loyalty in a platform and in a hotel? (Goal: understand how to drive retention and advocacy) ● What would make them loyal? ● Which elements would be included in a loyalty program? ● What is the role of loyalty in the booking process? ○ Are customers interested in points? ○ What is going to drive loyalty ○ Would transferable loyalty be enticing? ● What is the thing that keeps me here (in this hotel)? ● Advocacy: ○ In what case would you recommend the hotel? ○ What makes you post about the experience? ○ What makes you write a review? ○ How often do you write a review? ○ Where do you post your experience? ○ What will motivate you to share your experience? ○ When and why do you suggest a hotel to others? ○ What would excite you about advocate? ○ What would make them advocate for a platform? 5. [Perks] What kinds of perks/benefits are most valuable to guests? (Understand what value we need to provide to guests and how to deliver the most worthwhile experience) ● What in a boutique hotel can you monetize that we can offer on StayNow to incentivize the booking process? ● What offerings would entice them to choose 1 platform over another? Aka what kinds of perks and when to offer them? ● Which perks users expected? ● Which perks would make users come back to StayNow? ● Which perks can be offered to users through the StayNow platform? ● What incentives would work with the users? ● Are people interested in upgrading their status on the short list experience? ● What kind of perks are people interested in? ● What do StayNow has to offer to make them desirable? ● Is convenience something that guests are interested in? ● Do discounts or perks incentivise people to choose StayNow over others in the booking experience? ● What do the users care about? ● Rewards ○ What kind of reward do customers want? ○ How would the guest use the reward system? ○ What is the guest reward experience? ○ How are the rewards working? 6. [Driving Adoption] What will drive guests to choose one OTA over another? (Goal: Understand how to drive adoption and retention) ● How do we make guests change the

OTA that they use? ● Why will people come to StayNow and no other OTA? ● How compelling is for people the idea of booking a hotel because it is “local own” or “independent”? ● What do we need to do/offer to entice them to use a new platform? ● Can we educate customers about the internal struggle of independent hotels to make us choose StayNow? ● Who are this small group of people interested in decentralized hotel booking? 7. [Trust] What makes guests trust OTAs? (Goal: Understand how to drive adoption and retention) ● How do you build trust on the booking experience? ● How to build trust / What drives trust? (booking for an OAT exp. - Purchase exp.) ● What payment methods are trustful? ● Trust in payments ○ What are the forms of payment guests use? ○ What is the effect of payment methods on people? ● Trust in Crypto ○ Are guests interested in getting tokens? ○ What do people know about tokens? ○ Are people interested in paying in tokens? ○ How aware are people about crypto? ● Trust other OTA ○ Do people feel that they are treated less because of the book through expedia in an independent hotel? ● Why are people keep coming to a specific OTA? ● When do people use a particular OTA? Methodology The research will be conducted using moderated remote in-depth interviews to understand user behaviors, decision-making processes, and experiences across the hotel booking journey. Each session will be conducted via video call and will last approximately 60 minutes and will be facilitated by the Primary Researcher (Jamie). A notetaker (Suzanne) and up to one observer may attend each session. No more than three research team members will be visible during the session to keep the researcher-to-participant ratio as low as possible. After study sessions will be followed by internal debriefs to capture key insights. Weekly check-ins will be held with the respective stakeholders to discuss findings and progress. Participants Total of 10 to 15 guests who have booked independent/ boutique hotels Demographics ● Age Range: 22-64 years ● Gender: Any ● Country: United States ● Language: English Qualifying Criteria Individual who ● Has booked at least once an independent / boutique hotel in California in the last six months ● Have completed the booking themselves using an online or direct channel ● Has traveled for leisure Screener Questions 1. Please select your age range. [single-select] a. Under 18 ☐ Reject ☐ b. 18-21 ☐ Reject ☐ c. 22-24 ☐ Accept ☐ d. 25-34 ☐ Accept ☐ e. 35-44 ☐ Accept ☐ f. 45-54 ☐ Accept ☐ g. 55-64 ☐ Accept ☐ h. 65+ ☐ Reject ☐ 2. What state do you currently reside in? [written response] 3. When was the last time you booked a hotel/motel/inn for travel? a. Within the last 6 months ☐ Accept ☐ b. Within the last year ☐ Reject ☐ c. Within the last two years ☐ Reject ☐ d. Within the last 5 years ☐ Reject ☐ e. I don't know ☐ Reject ☐ 4. ☐ SKIP QUESTION ☐ Only ask rest of the questions if user selects option (a) as one of the option What method did you use to make the hotel reservation(s)? Select all that apply [multi-select] a. I used an online booking platform such as Expedia or Kayak ☐ Accept ☐ b. I booked directly with the hotel on their website or app c. I called the hotel directly by phone to make a reservation d. I walked into a hotel and made a reservation in

person e. Other___ 5. How was the trip(s) funded? [multi-select] a. I or a family member paid for the trip myself b. My company paid for the trip c. Another company/entity funded the trip d. Other ___ 6. Which of the following platforms did you use to book the hotel(s)? [multi-select] a. Booking.com b. Expedia c. Kayak d. Hotels.com e. Hotel Tonight f. Trip Advisor g. Trivago h. Get a Room i. Airbnb j. Other___ 7. Which of the following hotel loyalty programs are you a member of, if any? [multi-select] a. Marriott Bonvoy b. Hilton Honors c. Best Western Rewards d. Genius ☐Booking.com) e. Expedia Rewards f. Kayak Explorer g. IGH One Rewards h. Other___ i. I'm not part of any loyalty program 8. Which of the following best describes the type of accommodations you've booked within the last six months? [multi-select] a. Independent hotels (hotels that are independently owned and run) ☐Accept ☐ b. Boutique hotels (small inventory, design-driven, unique hotels) ☐Accept ☐ c. Chain hotels (hotels such as Hilton operated by the same company or owner) ☐Reject ☐ Other___ d. Motels (a roadside hotel designed primarily for motorists) ☐Reject ☐ e. Short-term homestays (ex. Airbnb, VRBO, etc.) ☐Reject ☐ f. g. None of the above ☐Reject ☐ 9. ☐☐CONDITION ☐ If they chose "Boutique hotel" or "Independent Hotel" give them this question What was your purpose for travel when you booked a BOUTIQUE or INDEPENDENT hotel? [single-select] a. Work b. Leisure c. Romantic getaway d. Family time e. Visiting relatives and friends f. Road trip Other___ 10. Who were you traveling with when you booked a BOUTIQUE or INDEPENDENT hotel? [single-select] a. Solo travel b. Travel with friends c. Travel with family d. Solo travel for work e. Travel for work with co-workers f. Travel with a significant other g. Other___ 11. For how long do you usually stay at BOUTIQUE or INDEPENDENT hotels? a. 1-night b. 2-3 nights c. 3-5 nights d. More than 5 nights 12. Please list the name of the accommodations you have booked between the last six months along with the states in which they are located. [written response] 13. What was your favorite or least favorite hotel that you stayed at in the past six months and why? [written response] 14. Would you be willing to share your screen if asked to participate in an exercise during the session? [single-select] a. Yes ☐Accept ☐ b. No ☐Reject ☐ Incentive \$50 USD per participant. Incentives will be processed 1-2 weeks post sessions. Discussion Guide Link to Discussion Guide Stakeholders ● Driver: Jamie Yoo ● Approver: Siddharth Raj ● Contributor(s): Grace Ang, Suzanne Peak, Padmaja Maddala ● Informed: Romal Jayswal, Saawan Patel Logistics ● UXReactor will recruit participants and connect with them ● UXReactor will schedule the interviews via Zoom/Userlytics ● UXReactor will provide the conference call link ● Each interview will be 60 minutes long and be conducted over Zoom /Userlytics ● Sessions will include audio/video recording (with consent)

Deliverables 1. Video Recordings -- scrubbed recordings from the study in mp4 or similar format 2. High-level Insights and Findings Report -- a report containing the findings, specifically detailing the Guest persona(s) 3. List of perks/offers/value propositions 4. Journey map 5. Questionnaire for quantitative survey Timelines Overall Duration: [Oct 31,

2020] - [Jan 20, 2021] # Date Task 1 2 Oct 31- Nov 11 Oct 31- Nov 4 Launch recruitment
 Finalize research plan Responsibility UXReactor StayNow and UXReactor 3 4 5 6 Oct 31-
 Nov 4 Pilot study Nov 14 - Nov 23 Formative interviews Nov 21- Dec 7 Jan 16- Jan 20
 Synthesis and report creation* Research readout* UXReactor UXReactor UXReactor
 UXReactor *Timeline is dependent on recruitment progress. Any changes to the timeline
 will be provided in advance during weekly syncs. Checklist The following tasks should be
 completed before the interviews: From UXReactor: ☐ Zoom/Userlytics link ☐ Sign-up
 sheet for observers ☐ Study protocol ☐ Dry run ☐ Screeners/recruitment ☐ Scheduling ☐
 Participant dossiers

Sample 2 — StayNow — Resea StayNow

Research Plan - Concept Testing Last Updated: January 25, 2021 Background & Purpose
 StayNow is an AI-powered end to end travel planning and booking platform that helps
 users discover, plan, and book trips in one place. The objective of this research is to test a
 low-fidelity prototype of the concept from ideation in order to minimize risk in the
 upcoming design sprints by ● Testing the viability of the proposed design concept ●
 Identifying the perceived value of the proposed design concept The findings of this study
 will be used to inform the foundational design of StayNow Guest experience, the scope of
 detailed design, and the product roadmap. Research Goals: By the end of this study, we
 should understand/know: ● Whether the destination-based model and overall product
 functionality are intuitive, understandable, and usable ● What value is required to
 motivate users to adopt and consider switching to a new OTA, including resonance with a
 platform built for independent hotels ● Whether users can efficiently search, evaluate,
 and make confident booking decisions on the platform ● Whether the platform provides
 sufficient and relevant information to support search, shortlisting, and final decision-
 making ● Whether shortlisting and collaboration features (e.g., wishlist, polls, chat) align
 with user expectations and effectively support group decision-making ● How users
 perceive payments, pricing features (e.g., price lock, pay-later), and overall trust in the
 platform ● How users perceive the end-to-end experience, including pre-check-in (e.g.,
 self check-in, virtual key), post check-out such as feedback behaviors (e.g., leaving
 reviews), and overall trust, satisfaction, and engagement Collated Research Questions 1.
 Concept & Value Proposition ● How do users understand the destination-based model for
 searching hotels? ● How do users feel about a platform built by small business owners for
 small business owners? ● Is the value offered by the platform overall compelling enough
 to consider switching to a new OTA? 2. Search & Decision-Making ● Does the platform

help users make faster booking decisions? ● Does it help users feel more confident in their decisions? ● Is the information provided sufficient to evaluate and select a hotel? ● What information do users expect during the search and shortlisting process? 3. Shortlisting & Collaboration ● Do collaboration features align with their expectations and mental models? ● Are users able to easily find and use wishlist (favorites) features? ● How useful is the wishlist feature for group decision-making? ● How effective is the property poll feature in helping groups decide? ● How effective is the chat feature support in helping groups decide? ● What other opportunities are there to create a more collaborative experience? 4. Payments & Trust ● What are users' reactions to the price lock feature? ● How do users feel about "travel now, pay later" options? 5. Pre-Check-in Experience ● How do users feel about self check-in options? ● How do users perceive the virtual key feature? 6. Feedback & Advocacy ● How do users feel about leaving feedback or reviews after a stay? ● How do users perceive incentives for leaving feedback? 7. Overall Trust & Experience ● Do users feel the overall experience is trustworthy? ● What factors contribute to or reduce trust in the platform? Methodology Moderated usability tests will be conducted remotely over video calls on Userlytics. During the interview, participants will complete 3 scenarios on a wireframe prototype in Figma. Each session will be conducted via video call and will last approximately 45 minutes and will be facilitated by the Primary Researcher (Jamie). A notetaker (Suzanne) and up to one observer may attend each session. No more than three research team members will be visible during the session to keep the researcher-to-participant ratio as low as possible. Each interview will conclude with an internal debrief between all researchers and observers who were present during the call. Weekly check-ins will be held with the respective stakeholders to discuss findings and progress. Participants Total of 8 guests who have booked boutique hotels Demographics ● Age Range: 22-64 ● Gender: Any ● Country: United States ● Language: English Criteria Individual who ● Has booked at least once an independent and/or boutique hotel in California in the last six months ● Traveled to the independent and/or boutique hotel for leisure ● Booked the hotel through an OTA Screener Questions 1. Please select your age range. [single-select] a. Under 18 ☐ Reject ☐ b. 18-21 ☐ Reject ☐ c. 22-24 ☐ Accept ☐ d. 25-34 ☐ Accept ☐ e. 35-44 ☐ Accept ☐ f. 45-54 ☐ Accept ☐ g. 55-64 ☐ Accept ☐ h. 65+ ☐ Reject ☐ 2. What state do you currently reside in? [written response] 3. When was the last time you booked a hotel/motel/inn for travel? a. Within the last 6 months ☐ Accept ☐ b. Within the last year ☐ Reject ☐ c. Within the last two years ☐ Reject ☐ d. Within the last 5 years ☐ Reject ☐ e. I don't know ☐ Reject ☐ 4. ☐ SKIP QUESTION ☐ Only ask rest of the questions if user selects option (a) as one of the option What method did you use to make the hotel reservation(s)? Select all that apply [multi-select] a. I used an online booking platform such as Expedia or Kayak ☐ Accept ☐ b. I booked directly with the hotel on their website or app c. I called the hotel directly by phone to make a reservation d. I walked into a hotel and made a

reservation in person e. Other___ 5. Which of the following platforms did you use to book the hotel(s)? [multi-select] a. Booking.com b. Expedia c. Kayak d. Hotels.com e. Hotel Tonight f. Trip Advisor g. Trivago h. Get a Room i. Airbnb j. Other___ 6. Which of the following best describes the type of accommodations you've booked within the last six months? [multi-select] a. Independent hotels (hotels that are independently owned and run) ☐ Accept ☐ b. Boutique hotels (small inventory, design-driven, unique hotels) ☐ Accept ☐ c. Chain hotels (hotels such as Hilton operated by the same company or owner) ☐ Reject ☐ Other___ d. Motels (a roadside hotel designed primarily for motorists) ☐ Reject ☐ e. Short-term homestays (ex. Airbnb, VRBO, etc.) ☐ Reject ☐ f. g. None of the above ☐ Reject ☐ 7. ☐ ☐ CONDITION ☐ If they chose "Boutique hotel" or "Independent Hotel" give them this question What was your purpose for travel when you booked a BOUTIQUE or INDEPENDENT hotel? [single-select] a. Work ☐ Reject ☐ b. Leisure ☐ Accept ☐ c. Romantic getaway ☐ Accept ☐ d. Family time ☐ Accept ☐ e. Visiting relatives and friends ☐ Accept ☐ f. Road trip ☐ Accept ☐ Other___ 8. Who were you traveling with when you booked a BOUTIQUE or INDEPENDENT hotel? [single-select] a. Solo travel ☐ Accept ☐ b. Travel with friends ☐ Accept ☐ c. Travel with family ☐ Accept ☐ d. Solo travel for work ☐ Reject ☐ e. Travel for work with co-workers ☐ Reject ☐ f. Travel with a significant other ☐ Accept ☐ g. Other___ 9. Please list the name of the accommodations you have booked between the last six months along with the states in which they are located. [written response] 10. What was your favorite or least favorite hotel that you stayed at in the past six months and why? [written response] 11. Would you be willing to share your screen if asked to participate in an exercise during the session? [single-select] a. Yes ☐ Accept ☐ b. No ☐ Reject ☐ Incentive \$50 USD per participant. Incentives will be processed 1-2 weeks post sessions. Discussion Guide Link to Discussion Guide Stakeholders ● Driver: Jamie Yoo ● Approver: Siddharth Raj ● Contributor(s): Grace Ang, Suzanne Peak, Padmaja Maddala ● Informed: Romal Jayswal, Saawan Patel Logistics ● UXReactor will recruit participants and connect with them ● UXReactor will schedule the interviews with participants via Respondent ● Each interview will be 45 minutes long and be conducted over Userlytics ● Sessions will include audio/video recording (with consent) Deliverables 1. Video Recordings -- raw recordings from the study in mp4 or similar format 2. Insights and Findings Report -- a report containing the findings from the study Timelines Overall Duration: [Feb 1, 2021] - [Feb 24, 2021] # 1 2 Date Feb 1 - Feb 3 Feb 2 - Feb 3 Task Launch recruitment Finalize research plan Responsibility UXReactor StayNow and UXReactor 3 4 5 6 Feb 13 Pilot study Feb 14 - Feb 16 Launch study Feb 20 - Feb 23 Synthesis and report creation Feb 24 Internal-Research readout UXReactor UXReactor UXReactor UXReactor *Timeline is dependent on recruitment progress. Any changes to the timeline will be provided in advance during weekly syncs. Checklist The following tasks should be completed before the interviews:

From UXReactor: ☐ Zoom/Userlytics link ☐ Sign-up sheet for observers ☐ Study protocol
☐ Dry run ☐ Participant dossiers ☐ Plan

Sample 3 — StayNow — Research Plan

StayNow Research Plan - Summative Research Last Updated: July 11, 2022 Background & Purpose StayNow is an AI-powered end to end travel planning and booking platform that helps users discover, plan, and book trips in one place. This study aims to test a low-fidelity prototype representing the concepts and workflows of managing reservations, managing accounts, viewing rewards and membership, and checking notifications on mobile devices. By doing so, this research study would gather insights that will inform the design process and help update and modify the designs before the V1 release. Specifically, the study seeks to achieve the following: ● Test feasibility and practicality of the proposed design concept. ● Identify the perceived value of the proposed design concept. The findings of this study will be used to inform the foundational design of Inn3's manage profile, manage reservation, manage membership and check notification experiences. Research Goals: By the end of the research study, we want to understand: By the end of this study, we should understand/know: ● Whether managing account (profile) fits user expectations and is perceived as trustworthy ● Whether inbox (notifications/messages) aligns with user mental models and supports communication with hotels ● Whether trips and reservation management align with user expectations and support efficient access to past and future bookings ● Whether membership and rewards processes fit user expectations and are understandable ● Whether the workflows (manage profile, manage reservation, manage membership and rewards, notifications) are understandable, valuable, trustworthy, and intuitive Collated Research Questions 1. Account Management ● Does managing account (profile) fit user expectations? ● Do users know where to update or change their information? ● Is there any information missing in the profile? ● Do users feel that modifying profile information is trustworthy? 2. Inbox / Notifications ● Does the inbox align with user mental models? ● Are users able to find or discover messages from hotels? ● How useful is the inbox feature for checking all activity notifications? ● What are user perceptions of the inbox feature's ability to enable swift conversations with hotels regarding specific requests or modifications? 3. Trips / Reservation Management ● Do trips order and wording align with user mental models? ● Are users able to find or discover booked hotels and those selected for future trips? ● How helpful is the trip list in allowing users to check past and future reservations more quickly? ● What are user

expectations for the itinerary feature? 4. Membership & Rewards (Loyalty Experience) ● Does the membership and reward point process fit user expectations? ● Do users understand how to improve their membership tier? ● Do users understand the benefits of their membership tier? ● Do users understand how to redeem their reward points? ● Do users understand the membership tier information presented? 5. Workflows (Overall Experience) ● Do the workflows (manage profile, manage reservation, manage membership and rewards, notifications) resonate with users? ● Are these workflows understandable, valuable, trustworthy, and intuitive? Methodology Moderated usability tests will be conducted remotely over video calls on Userlytics. During the interview, participants will complete 4 scenarios on a wireframe prototype in Figma. Each interview will last approximately 45 minutes and will be facilitated by the Primary Researcher (Suzanne). A notetaker (TBD) and 1 observer (Inn3) may also be on the call. No more than 3 members of the research team should be visible on the call, this is to keep the researcher: participant ratio as low as possible. Each interview will conclude with an internal debrief between all researchers and observers who were present during the call. Weekly check-ins will be held with the respective stakeholders to discuss findings and progress. Participants Total of 8 guests who have booked boutique hotels. Out of which to target 4 guests from past participants and other 4 guests of new participants Demographics ● Age Range: 22-64 ● Gender: Any ● Country: United States ● Language: English Criteria ● Individual who ○ Has booked at least once an independent and/or boutique hotel in California in the last six months ○ Traveled to the independent and/or boutique hotel for leisure ○ Booked the hotel through an OTA Incentive \$50 USD per participant. Incentives will be processed 1-2 weeks post sessions. Discussion Guide Link to Discussion Guide Stakeholders ● Driver: Jamie Yoo ● Approver: Siddharth Raj ● Contributor(s): Grace Ang, Suzanne Peak, Padmaja Maddala ● Informed: Romal Jayswal, Saawan Patel Logistics ● UXReactor will recruit participants and connect with them ● Participants will schedule the interviews via Respondent ● UXReactor will provide the conference call link Userlytics ● Audio and video sharing Deliverables 1. Video Recordings -- scrubbed recordings from the study in mp4 or similar format 2. Insights and Findings Report -- a report containing the findings from the study Timelines Overall Duration: [Jul 14, 2022] - [Aug 1, 2022] # Date Task Responsibility 1 Jul 14 Finalize research plan StayNow and UXReactor 2 Jul 17 Launch recruitment UXReactor 3 Jul 17 Pilots study (internal and external) UXReactor 4 Jul 19 Launch study UXReactor 5 July 19 - Jul 24 Summative interviews UXReactor 6 Jul 25 - Jul 31 Synthesis and report creation UXReactor 7 Aug 1 Research readout UXReactor *Timeline is dependent on recruitment progress. Any changes to the timeline will be provided in advance during weekly syncs. Checklist The following tasks should be completed before the interviews:

From UXReactor: ☐ Prototype ☐ Userlytics link ☐ Sign-up sheet for observers ☐ Study protocol ☐ Dry run ☐ Participant dossiers

Sample 4 — RallyUp — Research Plan

RallyUp Research Plan - Formative Research Last Updated: December 21, 2021

Background & Purpose RallyUp is an online fundraising platform that helps nonprofit organizations raise funds and engage supporters through digital fundraising experiences such as raffles, auctions, and donation campaigns. The platform aims to enable organizations and donors to collaborate in building communities around meaningful causes. The goal of this study is to discover what the best-in-class fundraiser experience is for a donor that will drive higher engagement and donations. **Research Goals** By the end of this study, we should understand/know: ● Who is the user and what is their journey like? ● What compels donors to participate or not participate in a fundraiser (across all stages of the journey)? ● What is the best fundraising experience from the donor's perspective? ● What is the donor's mental model for an auction, raffle and/or live event? ● Where does RallyUp meet or not meet donor's expectations? **Collated Research Questions** ● Who is the user and what is their journey like? ○ What motivates them? ○ How do they discover and engage with fundraisers? ● What compels donors to participate or not participate in a fundraiser (across all stages of the journey)? ○ What factors impact their decision to take part in a fundraising event ○ What information do they expect/need to know about the fundraiser ● What is the best fundraising experience from the donor's perspective? ○ What past events have left a good impression and why? ○ What about the experience made it easy/difficult to complete the transaction? ○ What impact, if any, does customization have on the donor's experience? ○ What are undiscovered opportunities we should pursue? ● What is the donor's mental model for an auction, raffle and/or live event? ○ What do they expect to see and be able to do in these types of fundraisers? ○ What information is most important to them when making a donation? ● Where does RallyUp meet or not meet donor's expectations? ○ What is going well in this experience? ○ What are the pain points in this experience? ○ Where can we simplify the experience? **Methodology** Remote in-depth interviews will be conducted remotely over video calls on Zoom. Each interview will last approximately 60 minutes and will be facilitated by the Primary Researcher (Jamie). A notetaker (Suzanne) and 1 observer (RallyUp) may also be on the call. No more than 3 members of the research team should be visible on the call, this is to keep the researcher to participant ratio as low as possible. Each interview will

conclude with an internal debrief between all researchers and observers who were present during the call. Weekly check-ins will be held with the respective stakeholders to discuss findings and progress. Participants Total of 8-10 participants who are either new or returning donors. Demographics ● Age Range: 25-54 years ● Gender: Any ● Country: United States ● Language: English Qualifying Criteria ● Individuals who have ○ Participated in an online fundraiser ○ Participated in virtual auctions and live events ● Both mobile and web users ● Novice users and new users ● Age distribution ● Can be new donors or recurring donors Screener Questions 1. Please select your age range. [single-select] a. Under 18 [Reject] b. 18-24 c. 25-34 d. 35-44 e. 45-54 f. 55-64 [Reject] g. 65+ [Reject] 2. What types of fundraisers have you made donations to IN-PERSON? [multi-select] a. Raffles b. A-thons c. Auctions [Accept] d. Events e. Sales f. Peer-to-Peer g. Ghostwriting [Reject] h. Sweepstakes i. Live Streaming Event [Accept] j. Crowdfunding k. I have never donated to a fundraiser [Reject] l. Other, please describe: 3. What types of fundraisers have you made donations to ONLINE/VIRTUALLY? [multi-select] a. Raffles b. A-thons c. Auctions [Accept] d. Events e. Sales f. Peer-to-Peer g. Ghostwriting [Reject] h. Sweepstakes i. Live Streaming Event [Accept] j. Crowdfunding k. I have never donated to a fundraiser [Reject] l. Other, please describe: 4. Which of the following methods have you used to make a donation? [multi-select] a. Mobile device [Accept] b. Desktop [Accept] c. In person d. Other, please describe: e. I have never donated to a fundraiser [Reject] 5. Which of the following platforms have you used to make a donation? [multi-select] [Randomize order] a. Kickstarter b. RallyUp c. Classy d. Impact Guru e. Ketto f. New Hands [Reject] g. GiveButter h. TeamRaiser i. OneCause j. GoFundMe k. I made donations in person l. I have never donated to a fundraiser [Reject] m. I do not have plans to make donations to fundraisers [Reject] n. Other, please describe: 6. In a few sentences, please describe the last fundraiser you donated to. Please write "N/A" if this does not apply to you. [written response] Incentive \$20 USD per participant. Incentives will be processed 1-2 weeks post sessions. Discussion Guide Link to Discussion Guide Stakeholders ● Driver: Jamie Yoo ● Approver: Kevan Mann ● Contributor(s): Suzanne Peak, Padmaja Maddala ● Informed: Steve Bernat Logistics ● RallyUp will partially recruit participants and connect UXR with the participant's email ● UXReactor will schedule the interviews via Zoom ● Each interview will be 60 minutes long and be conducted over Zoom ● Sessions will include audio/video recording Deliverables 1. Study notes -- debrief worksheets and any additional raw notes that were documented through the study (including participant dossiers) 2. Video Recordings -- raw recordings from the study in mp4 or similar format 3. Insights and Findings Report -- a report containing the findings from the study along with baseline metrics Timelines Overall Duration: [Dec 15, 2021] - [Jan 10, 2022] # Date/Time Task 1 Dec 15 Responsibility Launch Recruitment Support UXReactor 2 3 4 5 6 Dec 15 - Dec 22 Recruitment and Scheduling Participants Dec 20 - Dec 22 Pilot Study Dec 27 - Dec 30

Donor Interviews Jan 3 - Jan 7 Jan 10 Data Synthesis & Report Creations Report Readout

RallyUp and UXReactor UXReactor UXReactor UXReactor RallyUp and UXReactor

*Timeline is dependent on recruitment progress. Any changes to the timeline will be provided in advance during weekly syncs. Checklist The following tasks should be

completed before the interviews: From UXReactor's end: ☐ Sign-up sheet for observers ☐

Study protocol ☐ Dry run ☐ Scheduling From RallyUp's end: ☐ List of potential candidates

☐ Demo instances that support auction, raffle and live events

Sample 5 — RallyUp — Research Plan

RallyUp Research Plan - Concept Validation Last Updated: February 15, 2022 Background

& Purpose RallyUp is an online fundraising platform that helps nonprofit organizations raise funds and engage supporters through digital fundraising experiences such as raffles, auctions, and donation campaigns. The platform aims to enable organizations and donors to collaborate in building communities around meaningful causes. This study is a follow-up to the UX Ideation Workshop which took place on February 7th9. In this workshop, nearly 50 possible design ideas were generated, with varying predictions of potential value and varying levels of certainty for success. The purpose of this study is to mitigate risk in the upcoming design sprints by: 1. Bringing more certainty around what organizers expect to see, when they expect to see it, and how they expect to see it. 2. Measure the perceived value of concepts from the UX ideation session The findings of this study will be used to inform the foundational design of RallyUp's Organizer experience as well as the product roadmap. Research Goals By the end of the research study, we want to understand: 1. The organizers' expectation of the end-to-end experience a. What hierarchy and sequence of information makes the most sense b. Where and what kind of help they would find valuable 2. The organizers' mental model of certain concepts or phases in their journey a. Creation Experience i. How collaboration works, who do they collaborate with and for what purpose, what they need to collaborate effectively b. Management/Monitoring Experience i. ii. iii. iv. How performance is monitored What type of information is important What type is underserved/not served How the information/data is leveraged and used c. Donor Engagement i. ii. iii. Strategies for increasing engagement 1. Which factors are considered 2. What information is needed to develop a strategy Understanding the pulse of donors 1. How donor sentiment is captured/discovered (if at all) 2. How it is measured, any relevant

metrics (if at all) Relationship between donor segmentation and engagement strategy 1. What types of segmentation would they value 2. If segmentation data is gathered, how this information is used 3. What types of actions are taken 3. What organizers expect to do inside vs. outside of the fundraising platform 4. If the initial draft of the following workflows and frameworks resonate with organizers a. First-time experience creation via template b. Navigating to performance data c. Sending communication to a donor segment Collated Research Questions ● [End-to-End Journey] What is the organizer's overall journey and expectation from the platform? ○ What does the end-to-end fundraising journey look like for organizers today? ○ What are the key stages they go through from campaign creation to completion? ○ What are organizers expecting at each stage of their journey? ○ Where do organizers experience friction or drop-offs in the journey? ○ What are the most critical milestones in a fundraising campaign? ○ How do organizers define success at different stages of the campaign? ○ What are the biggest pain points across the journey? ○ What parts of the journey happen outside the platform today? ○ What drives organizers to switch between tools/platforms? ○ What would an ideal end-to-end experience look like for them? ● [Information Architecture & Flow] What hierarchy and sequence of information makes sense to organizers? ○ How do organizers expect information to be structured during campaign creation? ○ What information do they look for first when starting a campaign? ○ What sequence of steps feels most natural to them? ○ What information is critical vs. secondary during setup? ○ How do they prioritize what to configure first? ○ What information is missing or hard to find today? ○ How do organizers navigate between different sections of the platform? ○ What mental shortcuts or assumptions do they make while navigating? ○ What structure would make the experience feel simpler or more intuitive? ● [Mental Models] How do organizers think about fundraising concepts and phases? ○ How do organizers define different phases of a fundraising campaign? ○ What terms or concepts do they naturally use to describe their workflow? ○ How do they perceive "campaign creation," "launch," and "management"? ○ What does "performance" mean to them in a fundraising context? ○ How do they interpret donor engagement and success? ○ What concepts are confusing or unclear to them today? ○ How do their mental models differ from how the platform is structured? ● [Creation Experience] How do organizers create fundraising experiences? ○ How do organizers typically create a fundraising campaign today? ○ What steps do they take before, during, and after creation? ○ What information do they need to get started? ○ What parts of the creation process are most time-consuming or complex? ○ What kind of guidance or templates do they expect? ○ How much customization vs. guidance do they prefer? ○ What causes hesitation or confusion during setup? ○ How do they validate that their campaign is ready to launch? ● [Collaboration] How do organizers collaborate with others? ○ Who do organizers collaborate with during a campaign? ○ What roles do

different collaborators play? ○ At what stages is collaboration most critical? ○ What tasks require collaboration (e.g., content, approvals, outreach)? ○ What tools do they currently use for collaboration? ○ What challenges do they face while collaborating? ○ What features would make collaboration more effective? ○ How do they manage feedback and approvals? ● [Management & Monitoring] How do organizers manage and track performance? ○ How do organizers currently monitor campaign performance? ○ What metrics are most important to them? ○ How frequently do they check performance data? ○ What information helps them understand campaign health? ○ What information is missing or underserved today? ○ How do they interpret trends and changes in performance? ○ What actions do they take based on performance insights? ○ What kind of alerts or summaries would be useful? ○ How do they compare performance across campaigns or time periods? ● [Donor Engagement] How do organizers drive and manage donor engagement? ○ What strategies do organizers use to increase donor engagement? ○ What factors influence their engagement approach? ○ What information do they need to plan engagement activities? ○ What channels do they use to engage with donors? ○ What types of communication are most effective? ○ How do they measure engagement success? ○ What challenges do they face in engaging donors? ● [Donor Sentiment & Insights] How do organizers understand donor behavior and sentiment? ○ How do organizers understand donor sentiment today? ○ What signals indicate donor satisfaction or dissatisfaction? ○ How is donor feedback collected and used? ○ What metrics (if any) are used to measure donor sentiment? ○ What insights do organizers wish they had about donors? ○ How do they identify high-value or at-risk donors? ● [Segmentation & Personalization] How do organizers segment donors and act on it? ○ Do organizers segment their donors? If yes, how? ○ What types of segmentation are most valuable (e.g., behavior, donation size)? ○ What data is used to create segments? ○ How do organizers use segmentation in their campaigns? ○ What actions are taken based on different segments? ○ What challenges do they face in segmenting donors? ○ What level of automation vs. control do they expect? ● [Platform Boundaries] What do organizers expect inside vs. outside the platform? ○ What tasks do organizers expect to complete within the platform? ○ What tasks do they prefer to handle outside the platform? ○ What external tools do they rely on? ○ Why do they switch to other tools? ○ What would make them consolidate more work within the platform? ● [Help & Support] Where and what kind of help is valuable? ○ At what points do organizers need help the most? ○ What type of help do they expect (guidance, tutorials, human support)? ○ How do they currently seek help? ○ What makes support useful vs. frustrating? ○ Do they prefer proactive or on-demand support? ○ What kind of contextual help would improve their experience? ● [Concept Validation] Do proposed workflows and frameworks resonate? First-time Experience (Template-based Creation) ○ How do organizers react to starting with templates? ○ Do

templates match their needs and expectations? ○ What level of flexibility do they expect in templates? ○ What would make templates more useful or trustworthy? Performance Data Navigation ○ How do organizers expect to access performance data? ○ Does the proposed navigation align with their expectations? ○ What information should be surfaced first? ○ What feels missing or unintuitive? Donor Communication & Segmentation ○ How do organizers currently send communications to donors? ○ Does segment-based communication resonate with them? ○ What level of control do they expect while targeting segments? ○ What would make this workflow more effective? Methodology Remote in-depth interviews will be conducted remotely over video calls on Zoom. During the interview, participants will walk through their expected end-to-end experience, participate in a live site-mapping exercise, and complete tasks for a few core workflows on wireframe prototypes in Figma. Each interview will last approximately 60 minutes and will be facilitated by the Primary Researcher (Jamie/Kathy). A notetaker (Suzanne) and 1 observer (RallyUp) may also be on the call. No more than 3 members of the research team should be visible on the call, this is to keep the researcher to participant ratio as low as possible. Each interview will conclude with an internal debrief between all researchers and observers who were present during the call. Weekly check-ins will be held with the respective stakeholders to discuss findings and progress. Participants Total of 8-10 participants who are fundraising organizers (non-RallyUp). Demographics ● Age Range: 25 years ● Gender: Any ● Country: United States ● Language: English Qualifying Criteria ● Individuals who ○ Have taken part in the organization of a fundraiser ○ Responsible for setting up the campaign on the online platform ○ Monitors performance ○ Decides on what and how to communicate with donors ● Core Non-Profit ○ Annual budgets of \$200K-\$25M ● Novice and experienced users ● Have tried at least two platforms Screener Questions 1. Please select your age range. [single-select] a. Under 18 [Reject] b. 18-24 [Reject] c. 25-34 d. 35-44 e. 45-54 f. 55-64 g. 65+ 2. Which of the following activities have you performed for fundraising events? [multi-select] a. Conducting marketing, advertising, or promotional activities b. Volunteering for different activities c. Providing support for online donors d. Providing information about our organization to donors Tracking online campaigns e. Teaming up with another organizations and companies that can help the cause f. g. Managing social media and or web page [May Accept] h. Communicating with stakeholders i. j. Maintaining awareness of expansion opportunities Managing staff and volunteers k. Tracking online donations l. Delivering meals to prospective donors [Reject] m. Reporting and analyzing financial information n. Creating and managing campaigns projects [May Accept] o. Update information for online campaigns [May Accept] p. Other, please describe: q. I do not perform any of the above tasks [Reject] r. Setting up the campaign on the online platform [May Accept] s. Monitors campaign performance [May Accept] t. Communicating with donors [May Accept] 3. What is the name of your

organization?. [written response] 4. Which of the following best describes your organization? [single select] a. Non-profit organization b. For-profit organization c. School/Sport team d. Religious organization Other, Please describe e. Public/Civil service organization (example: police/fire departments) f. g. I do not belong to any organization [Reject] 5. Approximately how much do you raise in fundraisers annually? [single select] a. <\$200K [Reject] b. \$200K - \$1M c. \$2M - \$9M d. \$10M - \$15M e. \$16M - \$25M f. \$26M - \$35M [Reject] g. >\$36M [Reject] h. I don't know [Reject] i. Other, please describe: 6. Which of the following platforms have you used to raise funds? [multi-select] [Randomize order] f. a. RallyUp b. Classy c. Impact Guru d. Ketto e. New Hands [Reject] GiveButter g. TeamRaiser h. OneCause i. j. GoFundMe In person fundraising k. Other, please describe: 7. In a few sentences, please describe your primary job responsibilities and how you are involved in fundraising campaigns. If this doesn't apply to you, please write "N/A". [written response] Incentive \$100 USD per participant. Incentives will be processed 1-2 weeks post sessions. Discussion Guide Link to Discussion Guide Stakeholders ● Driver: Jamie Yoo ● Approver: Kevan Mann ● Contributor(s): Suzanne Peak, Padmaja Maddala ● Informed: Steve Bernat Logistics ● RallyUp will partially recruit participants and connect UXR with the participant's email ● UXReactor will schedule the interviews via Zoom ● Each interview will be 60 minutes long and be conducted over Zoom ● Sessions will include audio/video recording Deliverables 1. Study notes -- debrief worksheets and any additional raw notes that were documented through the study (including participant dossiers) 2. Video Recordings -- raw recordings from the study in mp4 or similar format 3. Site Maps -- visual representations of the overall journey 4. Insights and Findings Report -- a report containing the findings from the study along with baseline metrics Timelines Overall Duration: [Feb 15, 2022] - [Mar 18, 2022] # Date/Time Task 1 2 3 Feb 15 Launch Recruitment Support Feb 16 - Dec 22 Recruitment and Scheduling Participants Feb 22 - Feb 23 Pilot Study Responsibility UXReactor RallyUp and UXReactor UXReactor 4 5 Feb 24 - Mar 3 Interview Sessions Feb 25 - Mar 17 Synthesis & Reporting UXReactor UXReactor 6 Mar 18 Report Readout RallyUp and UXReactor *Timeline is dependent on recruitment progress. Any changes to the timeline will be provided in advance during weekly syncs. Checklist The following tasks should be completed before the interviews: From UXReactor's end: ☐ Sign-up sheet for observers ☐ Study protocol ☐ Dry run ☐ Scheduling ☐ Test prototype From RallyUp's end: ☐ List of potential candidates

Guidance

Use these examples as calibration references for:

- structure and section ordering
- depth and completeness
- research goal quality
- question-to-goal mapping
- participant rigor
- screener usability
- realistic logistics
- deliverable usefulness
- timeline quality
- execution readiness

Runtime Rule

When generating outputs:

- learn patterns from these examples
- do not copy client-specific content verbatim
- adapt structure and quality level to the new user input
- preserve originality while matching gold-standard quality
- prioritize user inputs over example specifics
- avoid repetition across outputs